Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI62 62% Fe Fines RMB/t

888
-10 -1.16%
Jul 31st, 2023

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

999
-10.80 -1.07%
Jul 31st, 2023

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

774
-2 -0.29%
Jul 31st, 2023

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI62 62% Fe Fines USD/dmt

109.07
0.79 0.73%
Jul 31st, 2023

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

154.87
0.00 0.00%
Jul 31st, 2023

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

980
-10 -1.01%
Week Ending Jul 28th, 2023

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2309 (Jan) RMB/t (3pm close)

841.50
7.00 0.84%
Jul 31st, 2023 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
August 23 USD/dmt

109.25
0.20 0.18%
Jul 31st, 2023 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2310 (Jan) RMB/t

3847
-4 -0.10%
Jul 31st, 2023 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

19.64
0.07 0.34%
Jul 28th, 2023

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

7.75
0.04 0.58%
Jul 28th, 2023

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

3790
60 1.61%
Week Ending Jul 28th, 2023

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

120.98
-1.06 -0.87%
Week Ending Jul 28th, 2023

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

12.04
-0.07 -0.56%
Week Ending Jul 28th, 2023

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

4090
190 4.87%
Week Ending Jul 28th, 2023

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Jul 31st, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	888	-10	-1.2%	869	880	858	892	115.97	-1.35	-1.2%	120.06	120.58	117.93	122.93
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	774	-2	-0.3%	813	798	761	793	101.75	-0.26	-0.3%	113.29	110.17	105.29	110.04
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	999	-11	-1.1%	981	992	970	1003	130.99	-1.40	-1.1%	136.05	136.43	133.84	138.73

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Jul 31st, 2023		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	109.07	0.79	0.73%	113.62	122.09	83.90	146.75
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	154.87	0.00	0.00%	127.72	139.70	94.45	154.87

MARKET COMMENTARY

DCE iron ore futures tight by 0.54%. the main contract I 2309 closed 841.5. some traders were active to sell, There are many inquiries from steel mills, but the wait-and-see sentiment increases as prices rise. total transactions remained insipid. PBF at Shandong port dealt 866-875 yuan/mt; prices are mixed today from last Friday. PBF at Tangshan port dealt 875-880 yuan/mt; the same as last Friday. There are three main reasons for the rebound in ore prices today: 1. Tangshan Environmental Protection Production Restriction has ended, the production of discontinued blast furnaces and sintering machines has resumed, and the production of molten iron has slightly increased. 2. PMI manufacturing data exceeded expectations. 3. Relevant departments have released news to promote consumption, boosting market confidence. During this period, news of crude steel pressure reduction interspersed, and iron ore prices fluctuated. In the later stage, mining prices are under pressure and difficult to rise. Or continue the volatile trend.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Jul 28th, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	980	-10	-1.0%	933	1021	770	1026	122.99	-1.14	-0.92%	120.04	136.07	94.72	137.26

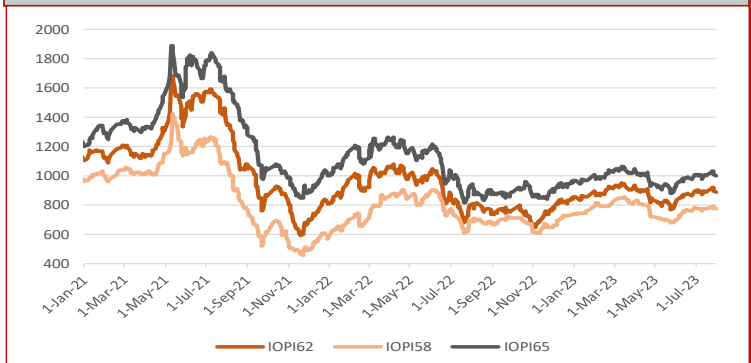
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Jul 28th, 2023				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1018	3.5%	779	1645	142.67	3.58%	110.31	255.69
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1080	1.9%	780	1630	151.36	2.01%	110.51	251.57
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	800	1.3%	620	1310	112.12	1.39%	87.40	202.32
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1033	3.8%	800	1752	144.78	3.94%	117.19	272.32

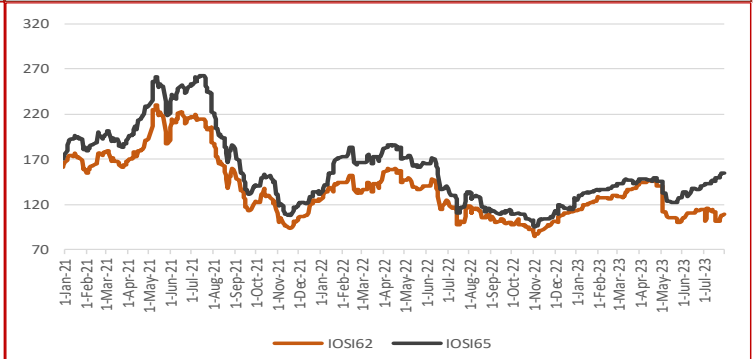
Week Ending Jul 28th, 2023	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	949.95	2.11%	706.36	1511.22

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 6.7522 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =6.87528

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Jul 31st, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	April	May	June	July	MTD	QTD	YTD	April	May	June	July	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	879	804	863	896	869	881	880	118.84	106.85	112.38	116.58	120.06	120.90	120.58
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	782	698	748	777	813	792	798	106.43	93.21	97.98	101.68	113.29	109.35	110.17
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	991	916	975	1008	981	993	992	134.47	122.23	127.41	131.57	136.05	136.72	136.43

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Jul 31st, 2023		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	April	May	June	July	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	144.76	108.53	110.54	108.57	112.14	113.36	122.09
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	147.67	127.20	135.30	147.39	122.86	127.49	139.70

FREIGHT RATES

Jul 28th, 2023		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	7.75	0.04	0.58%	3.57	16.77
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	19.64	0.07	0.34%	6.70	36.40

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Jul 28th, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	April	May	June	July	MTD	QTD	YTD	April	May	June	July	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	983	919	969	980	925	931	1032	132.68	117.67	121.33	122.51	119.39	120.08	137.99

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Jul 31st, 2023		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-114	-12.80%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	111	12.54%

Jul 31st, 2023		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	45.80	41.99%

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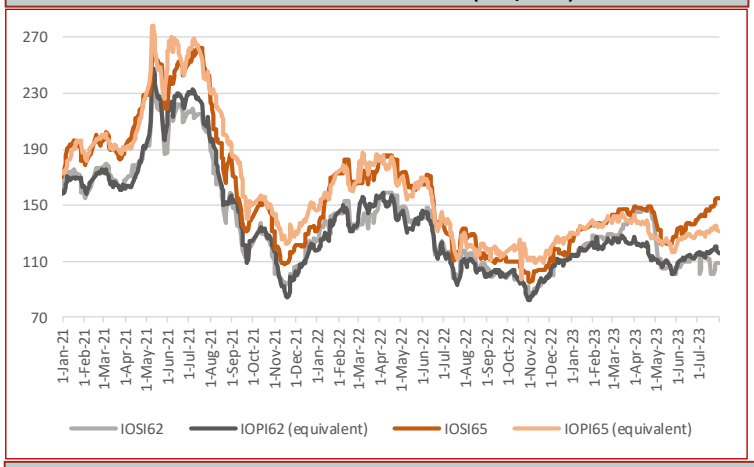
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Jul 31st, 2023	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	831	-10	-57
SIMEC Fines	761	-10	-127
PB Fines	856	-10	-32
Newman Fines	857	-10	-31
MAC Fines	838	-10	-50
Jimblebar Blended Fines	753	-10	-135
Carajas Fines	1069	-10	181
Brazilian SSF	853	-10	-35
Brazilian Blend Fines	869	-10	-19
RTX Fines	771	-10	-117
West Pilbara Fines	799	-10	-89

Jul 31st, 2023	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	104.55	0.80	-4.52
SIMEC Fines	101.05	0.80	-8.02
PB Fines	105.30	0.75	-3.77
Newman Fines	108.20	0.79	-0.88
MAC Fines	105.30	0.80	-3.77
Jimblebar Blended Fines	97.70	0.79	-11.38
Carajas Fines	138.60	0.80	29.53
Brazilian SSF	112.80	0.80	3.73
Brazilian Blend Fines	114.45	0.79	5.38
RTX Fines	98.95	0.79	-10.13
West Pilbara Fines	103.30	0.80	-5.77

Jul 31st, 2023	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	774	-2	0
FMG Blended Fines	784	-2	10
Robe River	784	-2	10
Western Fines	787	-2	13
Atlas Fines	781	-2	7
Yandi	767	-2	-7

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	13.00	2.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	25.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	25.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	25.00	0.00
	Low Grade Fe	13.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	28.00	8.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	24.00	3.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	37.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	5.00	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	39.00	1.00
	Low Fe Grade	5.00	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	14.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	14.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	1.25	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	8.25	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	8.25	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	8.25	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	3.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	1.25	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	8.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	5.75	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	3.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	5.50	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-100.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-30.00	0.00	Lianyungang	0.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-5.00	0.00	Jingtang	-5.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-30.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-15.00	0.00

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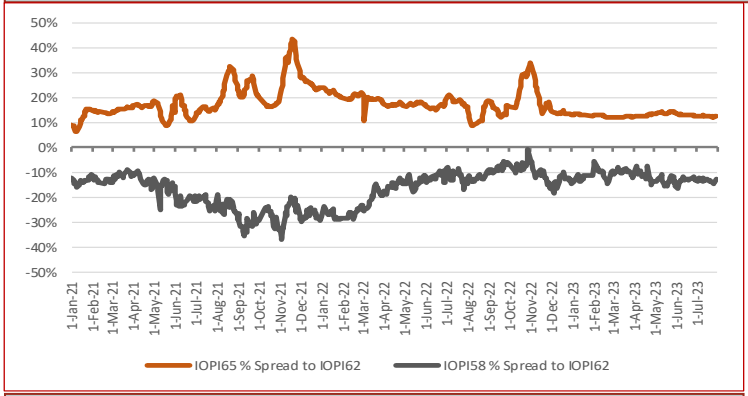
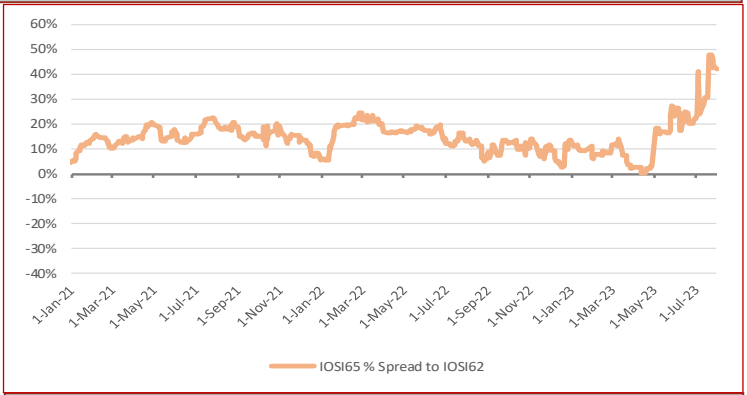
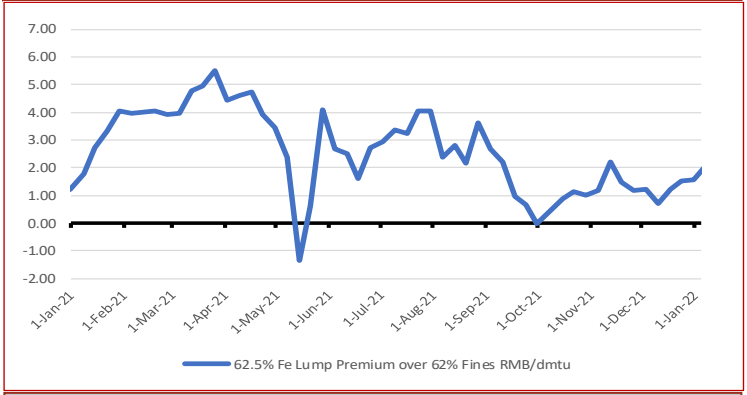
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

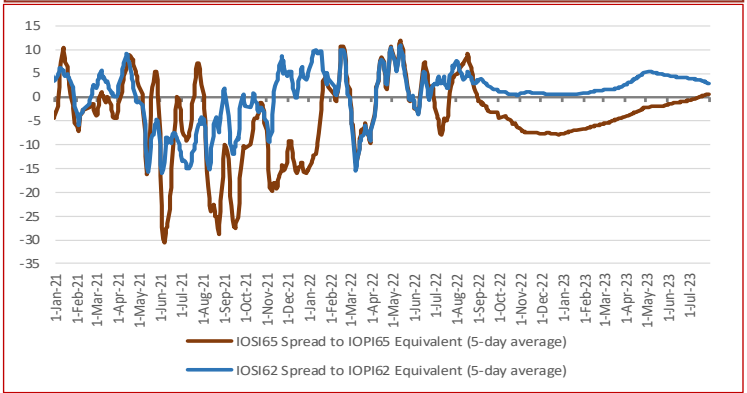




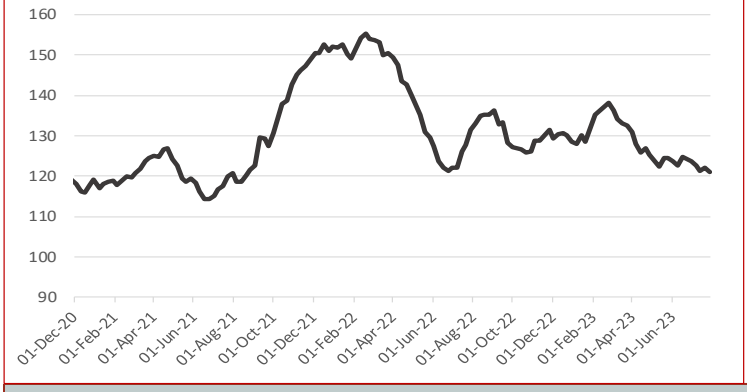
WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)



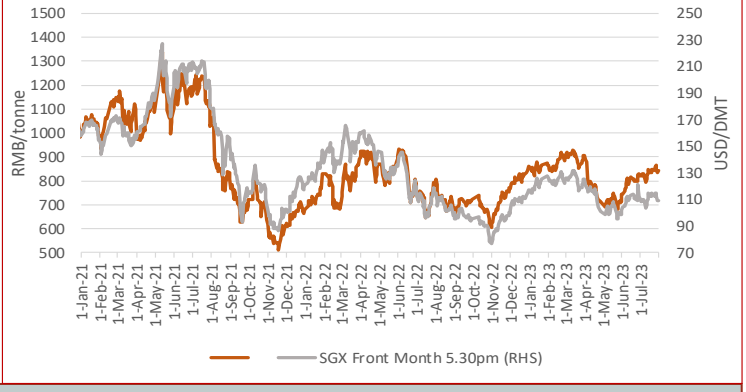
IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)



FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

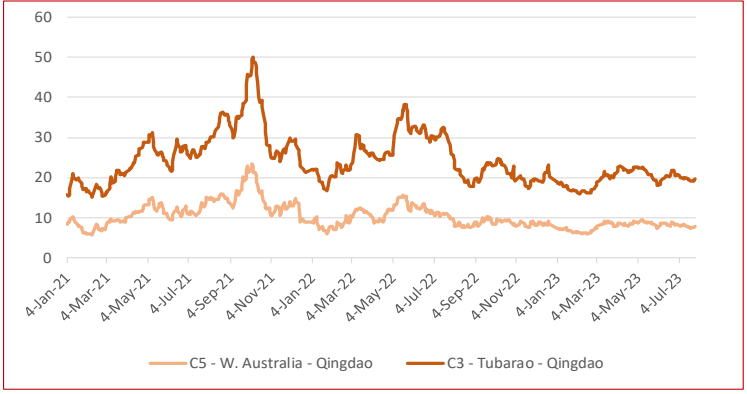
Week Ending Jul 28th, 2023

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	11.88	-2.06%	9.84	19.20
Qingdao	25.05	-1.14%	9.41	26.24
Caofeidian	11.03	6.57%	9.05	16.29
Tianjin	8.22	-1.32%	7.14	12.97
Rizhao	14.53	-5.71%	9.44	19.26
Total (35 Ports)	120.98	-0.87%	98.80	155.39

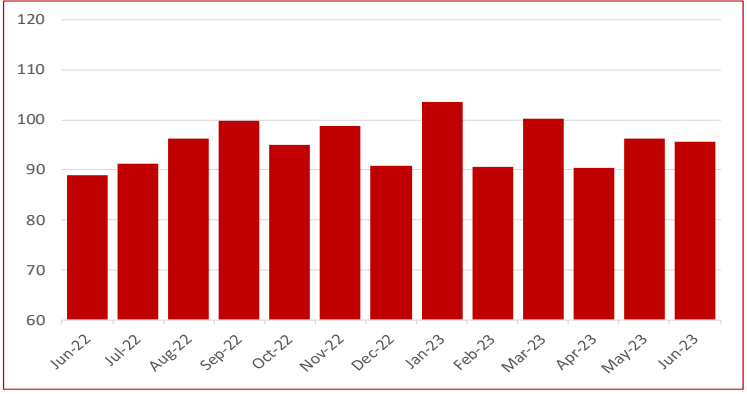
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Jul 31st, 3pm close			Jul 31st, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2309	Change	Change %	Aug. 23	Change	Change %
Closing Price	841.50	7.00	0.84%	109.25	0.20	0.18%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	47.12	-16.75	-26.22%	5.62	-2.29	-28.98%
Open positions ('000 lots)	57.18	-2.17	-3.65%	30.24	0.30	1.00%
Day Low	822.0	-2.50	-0.30%	105.75	-1.40	-1.31%
Day High	842.0	-10.00	-1.17%	107.85	-4.25	-3.79%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2023/7/28	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	3,790	60	1.61%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	4,020	60	1.52%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	4,090	190	4.87%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	4,650	90	1.97%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	4,050	50	1.25%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	5,000	80	1.63%
Colour Coated Plate	6,950	100	1.46%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

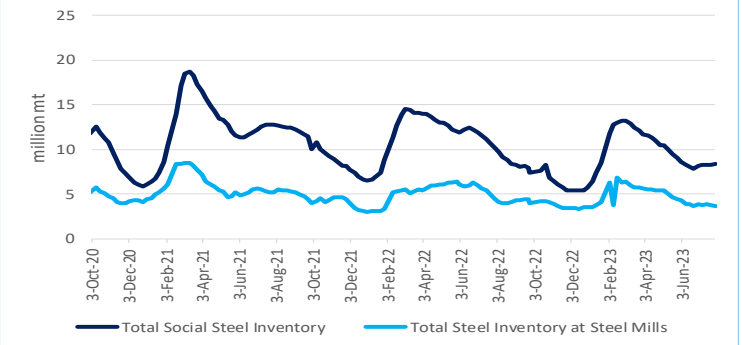
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	108.28	7	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	2,340	110	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	2,980	50	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	3,323	69	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	3,789	78	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	-89	-28	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	3,810	75	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	270	85	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

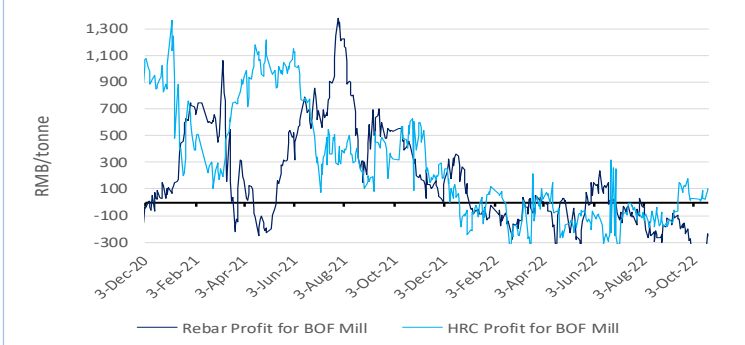
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

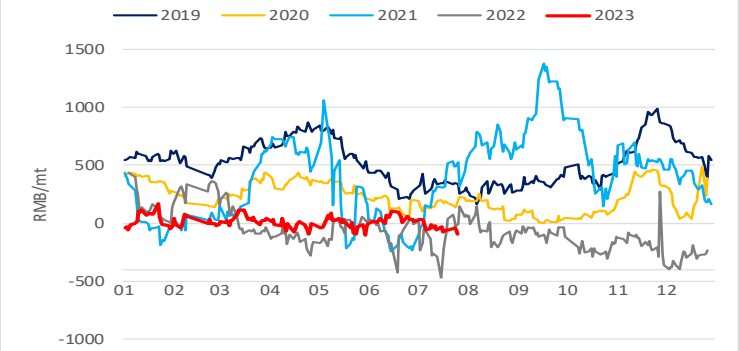
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



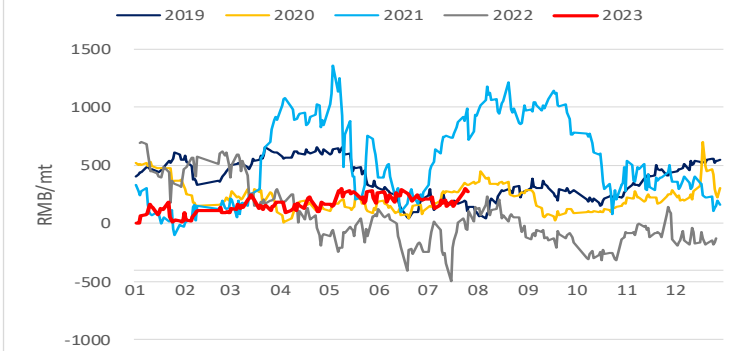
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



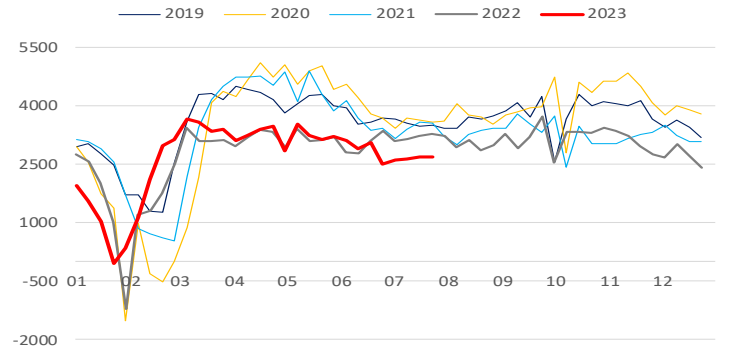
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



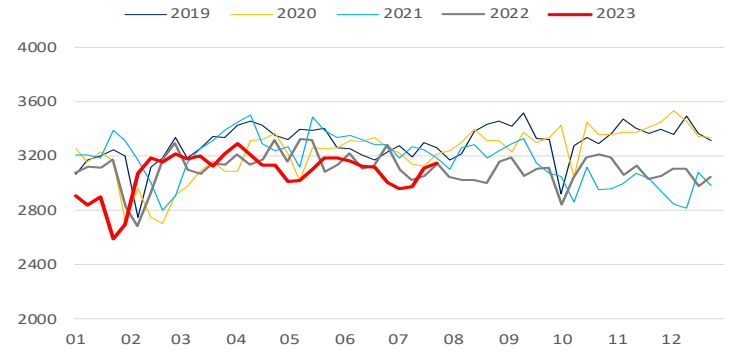
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



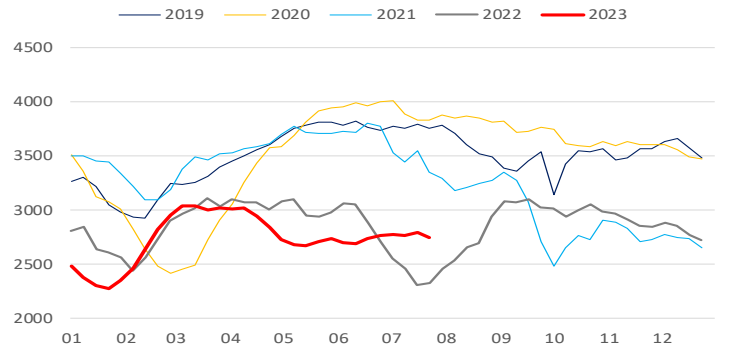
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



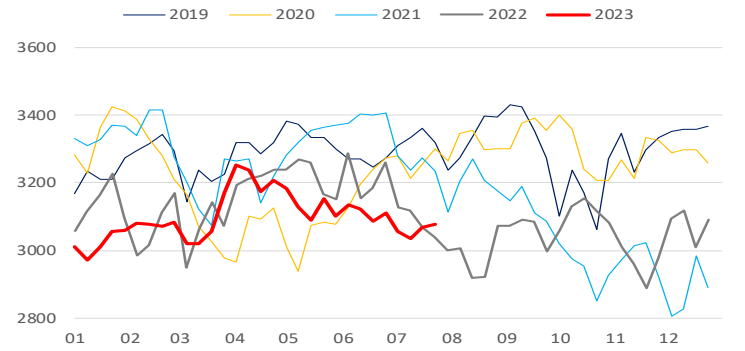
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

For more details on MMi's iron ore methodology please download the guide published on our website at: www.mmiprices.com

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Jul 31st, 2023	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Jul 31st, 2023	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.30%	0.095%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.40%	0.075%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.10%	4.80%	0.120%	7.80%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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